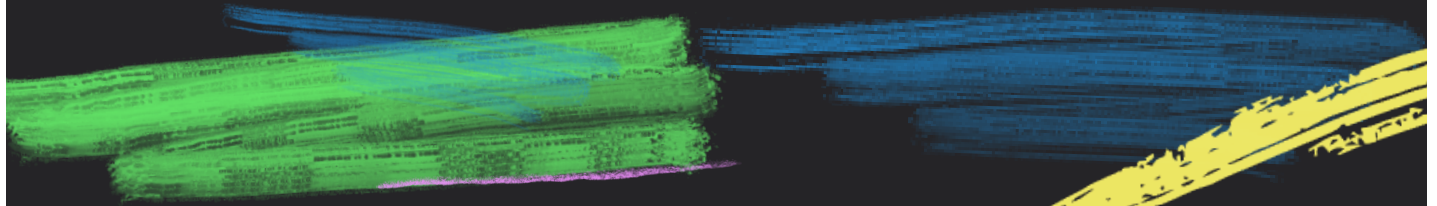




Engagement: Wellness Review

Our research found that we need to get closer to gamified wellness: points, badges, leaderboards and challenges that bring people back. Here's what we have, what competitors do, and what we'd do now.

Strategy brief · about a 7-minute read · October 2026



What is in here. What we found, what worked for us with Vitality, what competitors do that brings people back (each with a source), how status, points, recognition and life events should work, team rules, and our roadmap. There is also a [PDF of this document](#).

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SECTION 1

What we found

We set out to answer one question: what would make people open our app because they want to, week after week? To find out, we went back to what worked for us with Vitality, went through the Goodwill NE Texas admin dashboard on October 5, 2026, walked through the live NE Texas and Marion apps, and read how competitors describe their own products in their help centers and product pages.

The short version: we need to get closer to gamified wellness. Of the 12 things we'd do now, 4 are features we already have and need to turn on, 2 are already coming in Q4 2026, and 6 need building.

By gamified wellness we mean challenges, teams and leaderboards, points, status, badges and recognition. And we say **location** for the places people work or are served: a store at Goodwill, a school at Somerset, a clinic or office elsewhere.

The good news is that we aren't starting from scratch. We already have:

- 58 scheduled challenges at NE Texas, with step tracking, opt-in, a "Solo" mode that hides leaderboards, team views by location or department tag, and a Daily Consistency calculation;
- points from challenges and shoutouts that redeem for gift cards, monthly drawings, and a points ledger and redemptions log for admins;
- shoutouts with point gifts, images, comments and moderation, which people use heavily;
- HR sync with location and department tags; likes and comments, and a life events form, both coming in Q4 2026;
- **real services**: KOFE coaching, Findhelp, NeedyMeds, SNAP, LawHelp, crisis lines, career tools and MemberDeals.

The biggest surprise was life events.

Where we win. Competitors celebrate life events, but none we checked connect a life event to help ([Workhuman](#), [Nectar](#), [Bonusly](#), [Achievers](#)). With the Q4 life events form, we can celebrate a new baby and connect the family to resources in the same moment. We also serve the community as well as staff, and we're free to nonprofits.

SECTION 2

What worked for us before: Vitality

We ran Vitality before, and it taught us a lot about what keeps people coming back. Each week, people had a menu of ways to earn points, up to a maximum for the week: wellness checkup visits, team engagement challenges, knowledge assessments with quizzes, and more. Those points added up over the year toward bronze, silver, gold or platinum status, and started over the next year.

What we saw. The mix got people excited, and they kept coming back week after week. Team challenges did the most, because newcomers could contribute right away, even when they joined a team at the midpoint of a challenge.

That experience shaped how we read everything else in this review.

SECTION 3

What competitors do that brings people back

Next, we looked at how competitors describe their own products. We skipped the ads and read their help centers and product pages, where they explain how things actually work. We kept only practices we could find documented, and we flag the few we found at just one vendor.

A few patterns stood out: status that takes a year to earn, caps that reward steady effort over one big week, and celebrations that run on their own from HR data. Here's each practice, who does it, where we are, and our move.

Status Have Turn on Coming Q4 2026 Build now Next Later Skip

PRACTICE	WHO DOES IT	WHERE WE ARE	OUR MOVE
Status levels earned with points over a year, reset each year	Vitality UK †, Manulife Vitality †, Woliba (bronze to platinum with admin-set point ranges)	No status levels	Build now Section 4
Higher status, bigger rewards	Manulife Vitality † and John Hancock Vitality †: discounts and savings rise with status	Points redeem for gift cards	Build now Section 4; Vitality programs only
Points caps by day, week or year	Vitality UK †, MoveSpring , YuMuuv , Woliba	No caps seen	Build now

PRACTICE	WHO DOES IT	WHERE WE ARE	OUR MOVE
Badges awarded automatically for milestones	Vantage Fit : seven categories, including step levels, streaks and challenge completion	No badges	Build now one vendor; Woliba uses point-based badge levels
Streaks earn tiered badges, not point multipliers	Vantage Fit , MoveSpring (Streak mode)	Daily Consistency calculation	Turn on Build now streak badges
Automatic birthday, anniversary and new-hire celebrations, with company-funded points	Bonusly , Nectar , Guusto , Bucketlist , Vantage Circle , Wellable	HR sync; confirm it carries birth and hire dates	Build now Section 5
New-hire recognition as a sequence over the first weeks	Achievers (day 1 to 14), Bonusly , Guusto	None	Next
Life events celebrated by peers, with points	Workhuman , Nectar , Bonusly	Life events form Coming Q4 2026	Next Section 5
Shared team goals	Wellable : teams work toward "shared challenge goals"	No group goal challenge	Build now one vendor
Raffles for effort, not just winners	Wellable : weekly raffles for participants	Monthly drawings	Turn on one vendor
Challenge and team chat	MoveSpring , Wellable	Likes and comments Coming Q4 2026	Next
Seasonal, themed challenges	Wellable	58 scheduled on monthly themes	Have one vendor
Charity challenges and virtual races	Wellable ; MoveSpring Virtual Race	None	Next one vendor each

† The vendor page blocked automated access; the wording comes from its search listing. No competitor we checked publishes a points multiplier for streaks.

SECTION 4

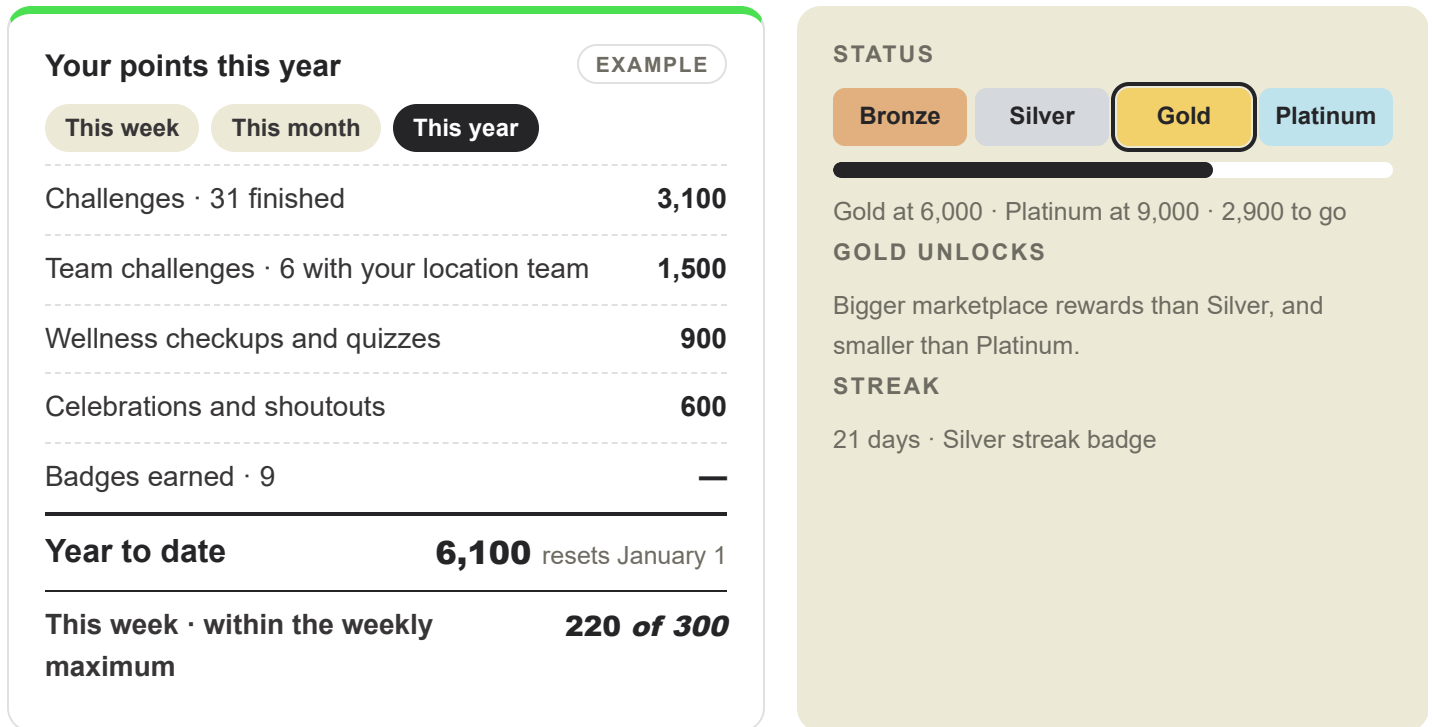
Status, points and the receipt

Status deserves care, because it's what people work toward all year. It should be hard to earn and should last a year, as it did in Vitality. [Vitality UK](#)† resets points at the start of each program year and sets Silver, Gold and Platinum at about a third, two thirds and the full yearly target (800, 1,600 and 2,400 points; [Manulife Vitality](#)† uses 3,500, 7,000 and 10,000). [Woliba](#) lets admins set the point range for each level.

- **Status:** points over the program year, with Silver at about a third, Gold at two thirds and Platinum at the full yearly target. It resets each year.
- **Caps:** a weekly maximum, as Vitality uses (MoveSpring and YuMuuv cap by day, Woliba by year), so status reflects steady effort rather than one big week.

- **Streaks:** streak badges that rise in tiers, as Vantage Fit does, rather than point multipliers.
- **Rewards:** higher status unlocks bigger rewards in the marketplace, as Vitality does with partner discounts. A points multiplier by status, like a premium card tier, is our variation on that; no wellness competitor we checked publishes one.
- **Receipt:** one screen showing points by week, month and year, where each came from, badges earned, status progress and the weekly maximum. Today only admins see the points ledger.

Here's how that could look on one screen:



Example values. The yearly target, weekly maximum and rewards are for the team to set.

SECTION 5

Recognition and life events

Recognition is where competitors are clearly ahead of us today, and life events are where we can get ahead of them.

Automate the dates we already sync. At least six competitors post birthdays, work anniversaries and new-hire welcomes automatically from HR data, with points the company funds ([Bonusly](#), [Nectar](#), [Guusto](#), [Bucketlist](#), [Vantage Circle](#), [Wellable](#)). [Guusto](#) notes that a missing birth or start date means no award goes out, so we need to confirm our HR sync carries both.

Life events by type. Competitors celebrate personal events when a peer or manager starts it ([Workhuman](#), [Nectar](#), [Bonusly](#)); [Nectar](#) keeps points out of sympathy and get-well cards. Our Q4 2026 life events form can do both jobs at once: celebrate, and connect the person to resources. The event types below follow Workhuman's list and Nectar's sympathy cards, and the resources are ones already in our apps. The pairings are our proposal.

LIFE EVENT	RECOGNITION	POINTS AND PERKS	RESOURCES TO OFFER
New baby or adoption	Team card and feed post	Company-funded points	Benefits information; Findhelp for local family services
Marriage	Team card and feed post	Company-funded points	—
New home	Feed post	Company-funded points	KOFE budgeting and housing counseling
Graduation or new credential	Feed post	Company-funded points	Career tools
Retirement	Team card and feed post	Company-funded points	KOFE financial planning
Loss or serious illness	A private support message; no feed post	None	Findhelp for local support; crisis lines when needed

SECTION 6

Team challenges and leaderboards

Team challenges did the most for us in Vitality, so we looked closely at how competitors set them up. On the basics, they mostly agree.

Teams	Scoring	Leaderboards
● Build teams from location and department tags, which we already sync; let people start or switch teams when the organizer allows (YuMuuv). ● At least 3–4 people per team, with an admin-set maximum (MoveSpring). ● Count late joiners from the challenge start (MoveSpring), which matches what worked in Vitality. Vantage Fit counts from the join date instead.	● Rank teams by average per member, not total (MoveSpring, Vantage Fit, Wellable+). ● MoveSpring counts members who don't sync as zeros, so teams recruit active members. ● An admin-set daily cap per challenge (MoveSpring).	● Show each person the five people ranked above and below them, with first name and last initial (Wellable+). ● Let people opt out of the individual board while still counting for their team (Vantage Fit). ● Turn on our "Solo" mode for sensitive challenges now.

Roadmap

Putting it all together, here's the order we'd go in. Much of the first column is switching on things we already have.

Now

Turn on, then build

• Turn on Solo mode for sensitive challenges

• Turn on location team boards

• Turn on Daily Consistency streaks

• Turn on effort-based drawing entries

• Likes and comments: Q4 2026

• Life events form: Q4 2026

• First name + last initial

• Group goal challenges

• Milestone and streak badges

• Yearly status: bronze to platinum

• Points receipt + weekly cap

• Automatic birthdays, anniversaries, new hires

Next

Borrow, then make it ours

• Life event celebrations linked to resources

• New-hire recognition sequence

• Challenge and team chat

• Charity challenges

• Virtual races

Later

Add when clients ask

• More devices via a data service

• Point multipliers by status

Already in Refresh: the foundation

Challenges · Step sync · Opt-in and Solo modes · Team views by tag · Points and gift-card redemption

Drawings · Shoutouts with point gifts and comments · Quests · HR sync with location tags · KOFE

Findhelp · NeedyMeds

SECTION 8

Build, partner or skip

We also had to decide what to build, what to buy, and what to leave alone.

The decision. We build the game mechanics on the engine and points ledger we already own, buy only the device-data connection if clients ask for more devices, keep partnering for services, and don't partner with or resell a wellness platform.

Lead with

- Life events that celebrate and connect people to help.
- Real services, not articles.
- Three audiences: workforce, community and public.
- Status that takes a year to earn and pays off in the marketplace.
- Free to nonprofits.

Skip Skip

- Biometric screening and condition programs (leave to the health plan).
- On-demand fitness class libraries.
- Reporting for boards and funders.
- Point multipliers for streaks.

SECTION 9

What we still need to confirm

Some questions the admin dashboard couldn't answer. We'll need product's help with these:

- ☐ Which devices and apps feed step tracking.
- ☐ Whether people can see "Teams by user tag" boards in the app, or only admins, and whether team scores are totals or averages.
- ☐ Whether late joiners count from the challenge start or from the day they join.
- ☐ How "Daily Consistency" works, and whether it can drive streak badges.
- ☐ Whether leaderboard names can show first name and last initial.

- ☐ Whether our HR sync carries birth dates and hire dates.
- ☐ What the Q4 2026 likes and comments release covers, and which life event types the Q4 form will include.
- ☐ Whether points rules can support a yearly status target that resets, and weekly maximums.
- ☐ Whether monthly drawing entries can be tied to challenge points.
- ☐ Privacy and agreement review for leaderboards, step data and life events, run in parallel.

SECTION 10

Sources

Competitor pages cited above, the program we learned from, and the services in our apps. † marks a page that blocked automated access.

Competitors

Vitality UK: status †

Status thresholds; points reset each program year. · vitality.co.uk/support/vitality-programme/getting-to-silver-and-gold

Manulife Vitality †

Status thresholds; partner discounts rise with status. · manulife.ca/personal/vitality/rewards.html

Woliba: rewards

Bronze-to-platinum badge levels with admin-set point ranges. · woliba-kb.groovehq.com/help/managing-rewards

Vantage Fit: badges

Seven badge categories, including streaks. · vantagefit.io/en/help/health-tracking/what-are-badges

MoveSpring: team scoring

Teams ranked by average; non-syncing members count as zeros. · help.movespring.com/en/articles/3804067

Wellable: leaderboards †

Five ranks above and below; last initial only. · support.wellable.co/hc/en-us/articles/360015562092

Bonusly: celebrations

Automatic birthdays, anniversaries and new hires, company-funded. · help.bonus.ly/en/articles/466903-types-of-celebrations

Nectar: celebrations

Life event boards; no points on sympathy cards. · nectarhr.com/recognize/celebrations

Guusto: automated awards

Birthday, anniversary and onboarding awards. · help.guusto.com/en/articles/6769369-all-about-automated-awards

Workhuman: Life Events

Peer-led life event awards with redeemable points. · workhuman.com/products/life-events

Achievers: celebrate

Service awards and a new-hire timeline. ·
achievers.com/platform/celebrate

Program we learned from

Vitality

Bronze-to-platinum status earned with points. Our team ran it before. · vitalitygroup.com

Services in our apps

KOFE

Financial education and coaching from Consolidated Credit. · consolidatedcredit.org/financial-wellness-program

Findhelp

Free and reduced-cost local services. · findhelp.org

NeedyMeds

Prescription savings and assistance. · needymeds.org

SNAP

Food assistance, from the USDA. · fns.usda.gov/snap

LawHelp.org

Referrals to free legal aid. · lawhelp.org

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

One of the crisis lines in the app. · 988lifeline.org



Refresh Software, Inc. · REACH · Public-Serving Division. Draft materials for review. Named organizations illustrate partner and provider types.

Competitor details come from their public marketing and help pages, October 2026. Vitality notes come from our team's experience running the program. Practices are cited to each vendor's own pages; anything that is our own proposal says so.